

THE ROSALÍA CODE

White Paper

A Theory of Attention Architecture

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Executive Summary

The Rosalía Code is a cultural theory proposing that meaning does not primarily emerge from objects, individuals, institutions, or stable centers of authority, but from the organization of attention.

The central claim of the theory is that meaning within cultural systems emerges as a result of the structured movement of perception. Meaning is not a static property but a dynamic process.

The Rosalía Code offers an analytical framework for examining visual culture, media, politics, art, and systems of social communication through the organization of attention.

The Problem

Traditional cultural analyses often begin with the assumption that meaning resides within an object, symbol, or institution.

The fundamental research questions are typically the following:

- What does this image mean?
- What does this symbol represent?
- What does this story tell?
- Who is the central figure?

According to The Rosalía Code, these questions are not sufficient.

To understand how meaning emerges, it is necessary to examine how attention moves within a given system.

The Original Observation

The theory originated from a choreographic observation.

During the analysis of Rosalía and Björk's performance, Berghain, a particular pattern became visible.

Although a seemingly stable center existed on the stage, the viewer's attention did not remain fixed on that point.

Attention continuously moved:

- between the performer and the dancers,
- between groups,
- through the rhythm of movement,
- and across different points in space.

Meaning did not emerge from a single element but from the process of attentional movement.

This observation became the foundation of The Rosalía Code.

Key Terms

Meaning

The interpretive effect generated through the organization of perception.

Perception

The process through which individuals encounter and organize sensory, symbolic, and cultural information.

Attention

The movement of perception across elements, relationships, contrasts, rhythms, and environments.

Attention Architecture

The set of structural conditions that determine how attention moves within a cultural system.

Orientation

The phase in which attention is directed toward a focal point.

Navigation

The phase in which attention moves through relationships, contrasts, and patterns.

Reconfiguration

The phase in which a new structure of meaning emerges from the movement of attention.

The Core Principle

The central proposition of The Rosalía Code is:

Meaning is an effect produced by the organization of perception.

Cultural systems do not merely communicate information.

Cultural systems create attentional pathways.

These pathways shape:

- interpretation,
- memory,
- emotional responses,
- and cultural meaning.

Attention Architecture

The theory introduces the concept of Attention Architecture.

Definition:

Attention Architecture is the set of structural conditions that determine how attention moves within a cultural system.

Examples:

- architecture → movement through space,
- cinema → movement through time,
- painting → movement across a visual field,
- media → movement through informational networks,
- politics → movement among symbols.

The Three Phases of the Rosalía Model

1. Orientation

Attention is directed toward a focal point.

2. Navigation

Attention follows relationships, contrasts, and rhythms.

3. Reconfiguration

A new structure of meaning emerges from the movement of attention.

Model summary:

- Orientation → Navigation → Reconfiguration

Comparative Analyses

The theory was examined across three distinct cultural domains.

Sonia Delaunay

The organization of visual attention through color, rhythm, and geometric relationships.

Alfred Hitchcock

The organization of psychological attention through information distribution and suspense.

Jacqueline Kennedy

The organization of cultural attention through symbolic representations, visibility, and public presence.

The shared conclusion of these analyses is:

Meaning does not emerge from elements in themselves, but from the way attention moves between them.

Implications

The Rosalía Code offers a new perspective.

It does not ask:

“What does this mean?”

Instead, it asks:

“How is attention being organized?”

This approach can be applied to:

- visual culture,
- media studies,
- political communication,
- the analysis of digital platforms,
- the examination of AI-generated environments,
- and the study of cultural systems.

Final Statement

According to The Rosalía Code, the foundation of cultural power is not merely visibility, resources, or authority.

Cultural power emerges from the capacity of a system to organize attention.

Attention creates structure.

Structure creates experience.

Experience creates meaning.

Meaning creates cultural power.

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